Business Insights

Five Key Business Insights

1. Sales and profitability vary across regions

The dashboard shows differences in sales and profit performance between regions. Some regions generate stronger financial results than others. This indicates that regional performance should be monitored separately rather than treating all regions as having the same performance.

Dashboard evidence: Sales and profit by region visualisation.

2. Product profitability is uneven

The dashboard shows that some products generate significantly higher profits than others, while some products have very low or negative profit. This demonstrates that high sales do not necessarily mean high profitability.

Dashboard evidence: Top and Bottom Products by Profit tables.

3. Product categories contribute differently to performance

The dashboard shows differences in performance between product categories. Some categories contribute more strongly to sales and profit, while others provide weaker returns.

Dashboard evidence: Category analysis and Total Sales/Total Profit KPIs.

4. Sales performance changes over time

The sales trend visualisation shows that sales are not constant throughout the period. There are periods of higher and lower sales, indicating changes in business performance over time.

Dashboard evidence: Sales Trend line chart.

5. Customer segments have different contributions

The dashboard shows that customer segments such as Consumer, Corporate, and Home Office contribute differently to overall sales and profitability. This suggests that customer groups have different levels of business value.

Dashboard evidence: Segment slicer and dashboard performance measures.

Three Business Risks

1. Low or negative-profit products

Products with very low or negative profit can reduce overall profitability. Continuing to sell these products without reviewing their pricing and costs could negatively affect financial performance.

2. Regional performance differences

Large differences between regions create a risk of relying too heavily on stronger-performing regions while weaker regions continue to underperform.

3. High sales without sufficient profit

Some products or categories may generate strong sales but relatively low profit. Focusing only on sales revenue could therefore hide profitability problems.

Three Business Opportunities

1. Focus on high-profit products
The highest-profit products identified in the dashboard provide an opportunity to increase sales and promote products that generate stronger returns.
2. Improve low-profit products
Low-profit products provide an opportunity to review pricing, discounts, shipping costs, and other expenses. Improving their profitability could increase overall business profit.
3. Target high-performing customer segments
The dashboard provides an opportunity to identify the customer segments contributing most to sales and profit and develop targeted marketing and sales strategies for those customers.

Part 5 – Business Recommendations

1. Promote high-profit products
Management should prioritise marketing and sales activities for products that generate the highest profits. These products can be promoted through targeted campaigns, bundles, and sales strategies.
Supporting insight: The dashboard identifies differences in product profitability.
2. Review low and negative-profit products
Management should review the pricing, discounts, shipping costs, and operating costs associated with low-profit products. Products that consistently generate losses should be reconsidered or strategically repriced.
Supporting insight: The Bottom Products by Profit analysis identifies products with the weakest profitability.
3. Develop region-specific strategies
Management should create strategies based on regional performance. Strong-performing regions can be used to identify successful practices, while weaker regions should receive additional analysis to determine the causes of lower performance.
Supporting insight: The dashboard shows differences in sales and profit between regions.
4. Focus marketing on valuable customer segments
Management should analyse the strongest customer segments and develop targeted marketing campaigns, promotions, and customer-retention strategies for them.
Supporting insight: Segment analysis shows that customer groups contribute differently to business performance.
5. Monitor profit rather than sales alone
Management should use both sales and profit KPIs when evaluating business performance. A product or region with high sales but low profit should not automatically be considered successful.
Supporting insight: The dashboard compares Total Sales, Total Profit, and Profit Margin, showing that revenue and profitability should be evaluated together.

Conclusion

The dashboard provides useful evidence about sales, profitability, products, regions, categories, and customer segments. The key findings show that management should focus not only on increasing sales but also on improving profitability, managing low-performing products, understanding regional differences, and targeting valuable customer segments. Implementing these recommendations can support more effective and data-driven business decisions.